

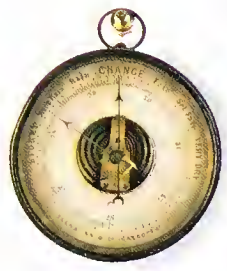


# Air



## Air pressure

Barometers measure air pressure – the weight of air pressing on the Earth.



Barometer

Air is a mixture of gases that swirl around the Earth. We cannot see, smell, or taste air, but it contains the oxygen we need to live and breathe.

## Air resistance

Air pushes against a parachute as it falls to Earth, and this slows it down.



Canopy

Air resistance makes parachutes fall slowly.



Harness

Parachutist

## Gases in air

Humans breathe in oxygen and breathe out carbon dioxide. Plants take in carbon dioxide and put oxygen back into the air.



## Wind power

Wind is moving air. It can turn wind turbines, which make electricity.



## Air currents

Air currents are pockets of moving air.

People use air currents for sports such as hang-gliding.

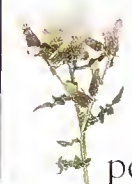


Birds use air currents to help them fly.



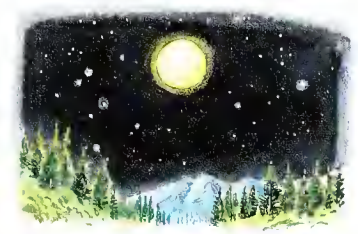
## Plants

use air currents to spread their pollen and seeds.



## Did you know?

Without air, the sky would look black even during the day!



## Air power

Hovercraft float above the sea on a cushion of air.



## Mountain air

On mountain peaks, the air is cold and contains less oxygen.



## Wind speed

People use the Beaufort scale when they want to measure the speed and strength of wind.



Light air – force 1



Gentle breeze – force 3



Strong breeze – force 6



Moderate gale – force 7



Strong gale – force 9

